

Employment and Workplace Policy

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Approved By: Chief Human Resources Officer, General Counsel

Classification: Internal - Mandatory Compliance

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 Purpose

This policy establishes the employment standards, workplace conduct requirements, and human resources procedures for Meridian Holdings Group ("the Company"). It ensures a fair, respectful, and legally compliant working environment for all personnel.

1.2 Scope

This policy applies to:

- All employees of the Company and its subsidiaries, regardless of contract type
 - All contractors, consultants, and temporary workers while engaged by the Company
 - All job applicants during the recruitment process
 - All workplaces including offices, remote work locations, and client sites
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2. Recruitment and Hiring

2.1 Equal Opportunity

The Company is an equal opportunity employer. Recruitment and hiring decisions are based solely on merit, qualifications, and business needs. Discrimination based on race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, disability, age, veteran status, or any other protected characteristic is strictly prohibited.

2.2 Background Verification

All prospective employees must undergo background verification before commencement of employment. The scope of verification includes:

- a) Identity Verification: Government-issued identification document
- b) Education Verification: Highest degree or relevant professional qualifications
- c) Employment History: Verification of previous employment for the past 7 years
- d) Criminal Background Check: In accordance with applicable law and position requirements
- e) Professional Reference Checks: Minimum 2 professional references
- f) Credit Check: Required only for positions with financial responsibilities exceeding \$50,000

Background verification must be completed before the employee's start date. Conditional offers of employment may be made subject to satisfactory completion of background verification.

2.3 Pre-Employment Requirements

Before commencing employment, all new hires must:

- a) Sign an employment contract or offer letter
- b) Complete all required tax and payroll documentation
- c) Sign the Company's Confidentiality and Non-Disclosure Agreement
- d) Sign acknowledgment of receipt of the Employee Handbook
- e) Complete the Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form
- f) Provide proof of right to work in the relevant jurisdiction

2.4 Probationary Period

All new employees are subject to a probationary period of 6 months from their date of hire. During the probationary period:

- a) Performance reviews will be conducted at 30, 60, and 90-day intervals
- b) Either party may terminate employment with 2 weeks written notice
- c) Benefits eligibility begins from the first day of employment, except where otherwise specified
- d) Successful completion of probation will be confirmed in writing

3. Employment Terms and Conditions

3.1 Working Hours

Standard working hours are 40 hours per week, Monday through Friday. Core business hours during which all employees must be available are 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM local time. Flexible working arrangements may be approved by the employee's manager subject to business requirements.

3.2 Overtime

Overtime work must be pre-approved by the employee's manager. Compensation for overtime is provided in accordance with applicable law:

- a) Non-exempt employees: Overtime pay at 1.5x regular rate for hours exceeding 40 per week
- b) Exempt employees: Not eligible for overtime pay but may receive compensatory time off
- c) Overtime exceeding 10 hours per week requires approval from the Department Director
- d) No employee may work more than 60 hours in a single week without HR approval

3.3 Remote Work

Remote work arrangements may be permitted subject to:

- a) Written approval from the employee's manager and HR
- b) The nature of the role being suitable for remote work
- c) Compliance with the Company's Information Security Policy
- d) Availability during core business hours
- e) Maintenance of a suitable and safe home office environment
- f) Regular attendance at required in-person meetings and events

Remote work arrangements are reviewed every 6 months and may be revoked if performance or business needs require it.

3.4 Leave and Time Off

The Company provides the following leave entitlements:

Leave Type	Entitlement
Annual Leave (Vacation)	20 working days per year (accrued monthly)
Sick Leave	10 working days per year (non-cumulative)
Personal Leave	3 working days per year
Bereavement Leave	5 working days for immediate family
Jury Duty	As required by law (paid)
Parental Leave	16 weeks primary carer / 4 weeks secondary carer (paid)
Marriage Leave	5 working days
Study Leave	Up to 5 days per year (with manager approval)

Annual leave must be requested at least 2 weeks in advance for periods exceeding 3 consecutive days. Unused annual leave may be carried forward up to a maximum of 5 days to the following year.

4. Compensation and Benefits

4.1 Salary Structure

The Company maintains a structured compensation framework based on job grades. Salaries are determined by:

- a) Market benchmarking data from reputable compensation surveys
- b) Internal equity considerations
- c) Individual qualifications, experience, and performance
- d) Geographic cost-of-living adjustments

Salary reviews are conducted annually in conjunction with the performance review cycle.

4.2 Performance-Based Compensation

- a) Annual Bonus: Eligible employees may receive an annual performance bonus of up to 20% of base salary for individual contributors and up to 30% for management roles, subject to individual and Company performance.
- b) Sales Commissions: Sales personnel are eligible for commission payments as defined in individual commission plans.
- c) Long-Term Incentives: Senior management may be eligible for equity-based compensation or long-term incentive plans as approved by the Board Compensation Committee.

4.3 Benefits

The Company provides the following core benefits:

- a) Health insurance (medical, dental, vision) for employee and dependents
- b) Life insurance at 2x annual base salary
- c) Long-term disability insurance
- d) Retirement plan with Company match up to 6% of salary
- e) Employee Assistance Program (EAP)
- f) Professional development budget of \$2,500 per year
- g) Wellness program and gym membership subsidy

5. Workplace Conduct

5.1 Professional Standards

All employees are expected to maintain the highest standards of professional conduct:

- a) Treat colleagues, clients, vendors, and visitors with respect and courtesy
- b) Communicate professionally in all business interactions
- c) Dress appropriately for the work environment and scheduled activities
- d) Be punctual and reliable in attendance and meeting commitments

- e) Use Company resources responsibly and for legitimate business purposes

5.2 Anti-Harassment and Anti-Discrimination

The Company maintains a zero-tolerance policy for harassment and discrimination. Prohibited conduct includes:

- a) Sexual Harassment: Unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, or other verbal, visual, or physical conduct of a sexual nature
- b) Workplace Bullying: Repeated, unreasonable behavior directed toward an employee that creates a risk to health and safety
- c) Discrimination: Unfavorable treatment based on any protected characteristic
- d) Retaliation: Adverse action against any person who reports harassment or discrimination or participates in an investigation

All complaints of harassment or discrimination will be promptly and thoroughly investigated. Confirmed violations will result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

5.3 Substance Abuse

The Company prohibits:

- a) The use, possession, distribution, or sale of illegal drugs on Company premises or during work hours
- b) Reporting to work or performing duties while impaired by alcohol or drugs
- c) The use of alcohol during business hours except at Company-sanctioned events where moderate consumption is permitted

Employees who voluntarily seek assistance for substance abuse problems will be supported through the EAP.

5.4 Conflict of Interest

Employees must avoid situations where personal interests conflict or appear to conflict with the Company's interests:

- a) Outside employment or business activities that interfere with Company duties must be disclosed and approved
- b) Financial interests in vendors, customers, or competitors must be disclosed
- c) Personal relationships with subordinates, vendors, or competitors must be disclosed to HR
- d) Employees may not use Company information, resources, or position for personal gain

All conflicts of interest must be disclosed using the Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form and reviewed by the employee's manager and HR.

6. Non-Compete and Non-Solicitation

6.1 Non-Compete Obligations

During employment and for a period of 12 months following termination, employees in management positions or with access to confidential business information may be subject to non-compete restrictions. Non-compete clauses must:

- a) Be limited to the specific geographic areas where the employee had responsibility
- b) Be limited to the specific business activities in which the employee was involved
- c) Not exceed 12 months in duration
- d) Be supported by adequate consideration (e.g., severance payment, garden leave)
- e) Comply with applicable local laws regarding enforceability

6.2 Non-Solicitation Obligations

For a period of 12 months following termination, former employees may not:

- a) Solicit or attempt to solicit any employee of the Company to leave their employment
- b) Solicit or attempt to solicit any client or customer of the Company with whom they had material contact during the last 12 months of employment
- c) Interfere with any existing business relationship between the Company and its vendors or partners

7. Training and Development

7.1 Mandatory Training

All employees must complete the following mandatory training:

Training	Frequency	Deadline
Code of Conduct	Annual	Q1 each year
Anti-Harassment	Annual	Q1 each year
Data Protection	Annual	Q1 each year
Anti-Bribery	Annual	Q1 each year
Information Security	Annual	Q1 each year
Health and Safety	At hire + biennial	Within 30 days

Failure to complete mandatory training by the specified deadline may affect performance ratings and bonus eligibility.

7.2 Professional Development

The Company encourages continuous professional development:

- a) Each employee has an annual professional development budget of \$2,500

- b) Employees may request additional funding for advanced certifications or degree programs
 - c) Study leave of up to 5 days per year is available with manager approval
 - d) Internal mentoring and coaching programs are available
 - e) Employees pursuing Company-approved certifications may receive a bonus upon successful completion
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8. Performance Management

8.1 Performance Review Cycle

The Company operates an annual performance review cycle:

- a) Goal Setting: January - employees and managers agree on annual objectives
- b) Mid-Year Review: July - progress check and goal adjustment
- c) Annual Review: December - formal performance evaluation and rating
- d) Calibration: January - management calibration to ensure fairness across departments

8.2 Performance Ratings

Performance is rated on a 5-point scale:

Rating	Description
5 - Exceptional	Consistently exceeds all expectations
4 - Exceeds Expectations	Regularly exceeds most expectations
3 - Meets Expectations	Consistently meets all expectations
2 - Needs Improvement	Falls short of expectations in some areas
1 - Unsatisfactory	Consistently fails to meet expectations

Employees rated 2 or below for two consecutive periods will be placed on a Performance Improvement Plan.

8.3 Performance Improvement Plans

Performance Improvement Plans (PIPs) are:

- a) Documented with specific, measurable objectives
 - b) Limited to a duration of 60-90 days
 - c) Supported with regular check-ins (at least weekly)
 - d) Reviewed at the end of the PIP period
 - e) If unsuccessful, may lead to termination of employment
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9. Termination of Employment

9.1 Notice Periods

Length of Service	Employee Notice	Company Notice
Probation period	2 weeks	2 weeks
Up to 2 years	4 weeks	4 weeks
2-5 years	4 weeks	8 weeks
5-10 years	8 weeks	12 weeks
Over 10 years	12 weeks	16 weeks

9.2 Exit Process

Upon termination, the following must be completed:

- a) Exit interview conducted by HR
- b) Return of all Company property (laptop, badge, keys, documents)
- c) Deactivation of all system access on the last working day
- d) Transfer of knowledge and ongoing responsibilities
- e) Confirmation of post-employment obligations (non-compete, non-solicitation, confidentiality)
- f) Final salary payment including accrued but unused annual leave

9.3 Termination for Cause

The Company may terminate employment immediately without notice for serious misconduct including:

- a) Gross negligence or willful misconduct
 - b) Theft, fraud, or dishonesty
 - c) Violation of the Anti-Bribery and Anti-Corruption Policy
 - d) Serious breach of confidentiality
 - e) Violence, threats, or harassment
 - f) Conviction of a criminal offense relevant to employment
 - g) Material misrepresentation during the hiring process
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10. Compliance and Administration

10.1 Policy Administration

This policy is administered by the Human Resources Department. Questions regarding this policy should be directed to the HR Business Partner or the Chief Human Resources Officer.

10.2 Policy Review

This policy is reviewed annually by the Chief Human Resources Officer and General Counsel. Changes must comply with applicable employment laws in all jurisdictions where the Company operates.

10.3 Record Keeping

Personnel records must be maintained in accordance with the Company's Data Protection and Privacy Policy (POL-DP-001) and applicable record retention laws. Employee files must be stored securely and accessed only by authorized HR personnel and the employee's direct management chain.

Appendix A: Employee Handbook Acknowledgment Form - See separate document POL-EWP-004-A

Appendix B: Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form - See separate document POL-EWP-004-B

Appendix C: Remote Work Agreement Template - See separate document POL-EWP-004-C

Appendix D: Performance Improvement Plan Template - See separate document POL-EWP-004-D